

1903.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA.
FOREIGN DEPARTMENT.

INTERNAL A.

Proceedings, May 1903, Nos. 110—115.

Presents from the Sultan of Muskat to His Majesty the King-Emperor on the occasion
of the Delhi Darbar, 1903.

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Internal A, B, or D.	Classification.			Month.	Year.	Nos.	Internal A, B, or D.	Classification.	Month.	Year.	Nos.
A	Internal	...	...	November	1902	141-46	ed	Int	May	or	6-7

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FOREIGN DEPARTMENT.

NOTES.

INTERNAL A., MAY 1903.

Nos. 110-115.

PRESENTS FROM THE SULTAN OF MUSKAT TO HIS MAJESTY THE KING-
EMPEROR ON THE OCCASION OF THE DELHI DARBAR, 1903.

TELEGRAM FROM THE POLITICAL AGENT, MUSKAT, DATED THE 25TH NOVEMBER 1902.

(Pro. No. 110.)

Requests that the Collector of Customs at Karachi be asked to exempt from customs duty the Sultan's presents for His Majesty the King, side-arms, stores and baggage brought by the Muskat deputation and Political Agent's party to Delhi.

Will the Finance Department kindly issue the necessary orders, sending us a copy.

27-11-02.

E. H. S. CLARKE.

Finance Department.

Under the proviso to section 20 of the Sea Customs Act, VIII of 1878, there can be no question of exempting from duty articles proposed to be presented to His Majesty the King. But I am not quite sure why there should be no

duty on the dutiable articles to be carried by the Muskat Political Agent's party to Delhi.

A. M.,—27-11-02.

Section 20 of the Act does not apply to the case. Exemption may suitably be granted on political grounds. Draft telegram for approval.

28-11-02.

R. A. MANT.

As modified.

28-11-02.

E. N. BAKER.

ENDORSEMENT FROM FINANCE DEPARTMENT, No. 6319-S. R., DATED THE 28TH NOVEMBER 1902. (Pro. No. 111.)

Forwards a telegram addressed to the Collector of Customs, Karachi, stating that the Sultan of Muskat's present for His Majesty the King, also side-arms and baggage carried by the deputation and Political Agent's party be passed free of customs duty.

TELEGRAM TO THE POLITICAL AGENT, MUSKAT, No. 5430-I. A., DATED THE 3RD DECEMBER 1902. (Pro. No. 112.)

Inform him that the Collector of Customs, Karachi, has been instructed to pass free of customs duty the Sultan's present to His Majesty the King, also side-arms and baggage carried by the deputation and his party to Delhi.

[DEMI-OFFICIAL.]

Dated Muskat, the 8th January 1903.

From—MAJOR P. Z. COX, C.I.E., Political Agent, Muskat,

To—SIR WALTER.

I saw Mr. Wood this morning and learnt from him that in the absence of any instructions to the contrary I was to take Seyyid Tanimoor and the other two members of the Muskat deputation to visit His Excellency the Viceroy at 11-45 A.M. to-morrow, together with the Sultan's present to the King.

Some articles that Seyyid Taimoor brought for His Excellency himself are to be sent to-day for inspection, and I am now bringing them, but write this in case I find you out.

I hope the Viceroy understands about these latter presents. Comparatively recently the Sultan informed me that he proposed to send some horses by his son for presentation at Delhi. I wired to the Foreign Department to ask if they would be acceptable; and the reply was (speaking from memory) that His Excellency did not desire any expensive present as none were being accepted from other quarters, but that if the Sultan cared to send any specimens of local manufactures, there would be no objection.

Of Local manufactures of which a representative selection could be put together there are none, and the Sultan hardly knew what to send.

He has sent—

- 1 Chased Silver Arab Dagger and belt,
- 1 Camel's hair cloak with Muskat embroidery,
- 24 silver holders for coffee cups,

worth in all about Rs. 300. Please excuse a somewhat hurried letter, time being so short.

The following articles were brought with a Kharita to His Excellency the Viceroy's Camp, Delhi, by the Muskat deputation for presents to His Majesty the King-Emperor from the Sultan of Muskat :—

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------|
| (1) 1 Gold Jug. | (6) 1 Benares Turban. |
| (2) 1 Cutter with gold scabbard and belt. | (7) 2 Kurjas (carpet bags). |
| (3) 1 Gold powder flask. | (8) 3 Carpets. |
| (4) 1 Sword with gold scabbard. | (9) 2 Leather pouch belts. |
| (5) 1 Shield with gold knobs. | (10) 1 Leather sword belt. |
| | (11) 2 Pairs of Chapeli shoes. |

Of the above articles His Excellency ordered me verbally to send Nos. (1) to (5) to His Majesty.

The following articles were also brought for presentation to His Excellency the Viceroy.*
 * *P de* demi-official dated the 8th January 1903, I received 2 silver holders for coffee cups short, from Political Agent, Muskat, to the Private Secretary to the Viceroy put up. and I brought this to the notice of the Secretary. The dagger was not given to the Teshakhana. Please see pencil remark on the demi-official mentioned in the margin, page 1.—

- (1) 1 Camel's hair cloak with Muskat embroidery.
- (2) 22 Silver holders for coffee cups.

B. N. C.,—23-1-03.

Telegram, dated the 30th January 1903.

From—The Foreign Secretary, Calcutta,

To—The Political Agent, Muskat, *via* Jask.

My telegram 23rd September last. Were Sultan's presents of antelopes and goat despatched to London; if so, when?

Telegram, dated the 31st January 1903.

From—The Political Agent, Muskat,

To—The Foreign Secretary, Calcutta.

Sultan's present of antelopes and goat not yet sent.

7.2.03. — 255mc. 140

Telegram, dated the 7th February 1903.

From—The Foreign Secretary, Calcutta,

To—The Political Agent, Maskat, *via* Jask.

Your telegram 31st January. Antelopes and goat should be sent direct to London. Please say when they will be despatched.

Telegram, dated the 8th February 1903.

From—Political Agent, Muskat,

To—The Foreign Secretary, Calcutta.

Your telegram of 7th February last. One antelope and goat dead. Arrangements being made to procure others which will be despatched after Cox returns.

A draft despatch about the Muskat presents is submitted for Your Excellency's approval.

17-2-03.

L. W. DANE.

18-2-03.

C[URZON].

DESPATCH TO SECRETARY OF STATE FOR INDIA, No 22 (INTERNAL), DATED THE 26TH FEBRUARY (Pro. No. 113) 1903.

Advises the despatch of certain presents tendered to His Majesty the King-Emperor by the Sultan of Muskat on the occasion of the Delhi Darbar.

[DEMI-OFFICIAL.]

Dated the 21st February 1903.

From - MAJOR P. Z. COX., C.I.E., Political Agent, Muskat.

To - C. L. S. RUSSELL, Esq., Officiating Under-Secretary to the Government of India, Foreign Department.

Kindly refer to the correspondence on the subject of the Sultan's presents to the King.

On the 31st May 1902 I wrote to Mr. Barnes that "the despatch of the animals can be got out of owing to the proximity of the monsoon."

Between the conclusion of the monsoon and my leaving for Delhi no homeward bound ship called at Muskat, and moreover after November the animals would without doubt have died *en route* from the cold. Now, on my return to Muskat, I find that only one is left, a female Oryx. She is not fit to send by herself, and I therefore recommend that the idea of sending any be given up for the present, as it is impossible to get more to order. If any more specimens are obtained by the Sultan later on and an opportunity occurs of getting them home direct, I will take advantage of it and let the Foreign Department know in good time.

This seems to partially nullify paragraph 2 of our despatch below. We may explain demi-officially to the India Office in a letter to Mr. Ritchie?

M. L. G.,—5-3-03.

5-3-03.

F. S. COWIE.

Two drafts put up for approval.

J. T.,—9-3-03.

11-3-03.

F. S. COWIE.

To see. Nothing need be done at present, see paragraph 2 of the despatch.

13-3-03.

O. V. BOSANQUET.

13-3-03.

L. W. DANE.

MEMO. TO THE SUPERINTENDENT, GOVERNMENT TOSHAKHANA, DATED THE 10TH APRIL 1903. (Pro. No. 114.)

Requests him to bring on his books certain articles presented by the Marri and Bugti Sardars to His Excellency the Viceroy.

MEMO. TO THE SUPERINTENDENT, GOVERNMENT TOSHAKHANA, DATED THE 10TH APRIL 1903. (Pro. No. 115.)

Requests him to bring on his books certain articles presented by the Sultan of Muskat to His Excellency the Viceroy.

PROCEEDINGS OF THE
FOREIGN DEPARTMENT, INTERNAL A., MAY 1903.

PRESENTS FROM THE SULTAN OF MUSKAT TO HIS MAJESTY THE KING-EMPEROR ON THE OCCASION OF THE DEDHI DARBAR, 1903.

Telegram, dated Muskat, the 25th November 1902.

Pro. No. 110.

From—The Political Agent, Muskat,

To—The Foreign Secretary, Viceroy's Camp.

I request favour of Collector of Customs at Karachi being asked to exempt from customs duty Sultan's presents for King and side-arms, stores and baggage carried by deputation and my party to Delhi.

Telegram No. 6318-S. R., dated Calcutta, the 28th November 1902.

Pro. No. 111.

From—The Finance Secretary, Calcutta,

To—The Collector of Customs, Karachi.

Please pass free of customs duty Sultan Muskat's present for King, also side-arms and baggage if carried by deputation and Political Agent's party.

No. 6319-S. R., dated Calcutta, the 28th November 1902.

Endorsed by the Government of India, Finance Department.

Copy forwarded to the Foreign Department and the Government of Bombay.

No. 5430-I. A., dated Fort William, the 3rd December 1902.

Pro. No. 112.

From—The Foreign Secretary, Calcutta,

To—The Political Agent, Muskat.

Your telegram November 25th. Collector instructed to pass free of customs duty Sultan's present to King, also side-arms and baggage if carried by deputation and your party.

2

Pro. No. 113.

No. 22 of 1903.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA.

FOREIGN DEPARTMENT.

INTERNAL.

To

THE RIGHT HON'BLE LORD GEORGE F. HAMILTON, G.C.S.I.,
His Majesty's Secretary of State for India.

FORT WILLIAM, the 26th February 1903.

MY LORD,

In accordance with the suggestion contained in Your Lordship's telegram, dated the 23rd April 1902, the Political Agent at Maskat, acting under our instructions, advised His Highness the Sultan not to tender his Coronation presents to His Majesty the King, Emperor of India, until the occasion of the Durbar at Delhi.

2. The gifts included two antelopes and a goat, which the Political Agent was subsequently authorised to ship direct to London. Before they could be despatched, however, one antelope and the goat died, and others are now being procured in their place.

3. The remainder of the gifts, of which a list is given in the margin, were brought to Delhi by the Sultan's son, who represented His Highness at the Durbar, and were delivered by him to His Excellency the Viceroy for transmission to His Majesty.

1 Gold jug.
1 Dagger with gold scabbard and belt.
1 Gold powder flask.
1 Sword with gold scabbard.
1 Shield with gold bosses.

They were despatched from Calcutta to Your Lordship on the 12th February 1903 in the S.S. "Goorkha", and the Agent for Government Consignments at Calcutta has been instructed to transmit the bill-of-lading to the Superintendent of the India Store Depot.

4. The gifts were accompanied by a *kharita* addressed to His Majesty the King, Emperor of India. The *kharita*, together with an English translation thereof, is sent herewith. We would suggest that the Sultan's presents should be acknowledged under His Majesty's autograph.

5. As some return, in addition to lending to His Highness the Sultan a sum of £10,000 for the purchase of a steamer, we intend to present him with a Nordenfeldt machine gun and a 9-pounder gun which we understand that he is anxious to obtain for this vessel.

We have the honour to be,

MY LORD,

Your Lordship's most obedient, humble servants,

(Signed) CURZON.

„ KITCHENER.

„ T. RALEIGH.

„ E. F.-G. LAW.

„ E. R. ELLES.

„ A. T. ARUNDEL.

„ DENZIL IBBETSON.

4
Dated Maskat, the 1st December 1902.

From—HIS HIGHNESS FEYSAL-BIN-TURKI-BIN-SAEED, Sultan of Maskat,

To—HIS MOST EXCELLENT MAJESTY KING EDWARD VII, King of Great Britain and Ireland and of all the British Dominions beyond the Seas, Defender of the Faith, Emperor of India. May his fame and prosperity be perpetual, and may he never cease to flourish in splendour and magnificence as long as the days and nights revolve.

*Encl. in
No. 113.*

After greeting.—May it be known to Your Majesty that it was my intention to have offered for Your Majesty's acceptance an humble present on the occasion of Your Coronation (of auspicious omen) in London, but owing to the absence on a journey in the interior of Oman of Your Majesty's Representative in Maskat, who had undertaken to forward the articles, it was impossible to transmit them to England in time.

On my communicating, however, with Your Majesty's Viceroy in India, His Excellency kindly consented to receive them and to cause their despatch to Your Majesty, and accordingly I am forwarding them by the hand of my eldest son, Taimur, who is representing me at Delhi by the gracious invitation of the Viceroy, in order that they may in due course be transmitted to their destination.

I venture to hope that Your Most Excellent Majesty will accept them as a small token of my personal esteem and in virtue of the ancient ties of friendship that have existed between Great England and my forefathers, and as an expression of my grateful attachment to Your Majesty and to the English throne.

May Your Majesty be preserved.

PROCEEDINGS OF THE
FOREIGN DEPARTMENT, INTERNAL A., MAY 1903.

Dated Simla, the 10th April 1903.

Pro. No. 114.

Endorsed by the Government of India, Foreign Department.

The Superintendent of the Toshakhana is directed to bring on his books, at the value stated opposite each, the under-mentioned articles which have been presented by the Marri and Bugti Sardars to His Excellency the Viceroy.

Articles.	Value.		
	Rs.	A.	P.
1 Benares Turban	10	0	0
1 Kurja (carpet bag)	10	0	0
1 Kurja (carpet bag)	10	0	0
1 Carpet	10	0	0
1 Carpet	20	0	0
1 Carpet	25	0	0
1 Leather pouch belt	8	0	0
1 Leather pouch belt	8	0	0
1 Leather sword belt	5	0	0
1 Pair Chapeli shoes	0	8	0
1 Pair Chapeli shoes	0	8	0

Dated Simla, the 10th April 1903.

Pro. No. 115.

Endorsed by the Government of India, Foreign Department.

The Superintendent of the Toshakhana is directed to bring on his books, at the value stated opposite each, the under-mentioned articles which have been presented by the Sultan of Muskat to His Excellency the Viceroy.

Articles.	Value.		
	Rs.	A.	P.
1 Camel hair cloak with Muskat embroidery	15	0	0
22 Silver holders for coffee cups	54	0	0